THE DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

4 Week Hybrid Engine Program

BUILD THE ENGINE. BRIDGE THE GAP.

Program focus

This 4 week program is built for HYROX athletes who want to bridge the gap between fresh speed and compromised race speed. The system develops the engine, trains the flush, and teaches the athlete to restore control while still moving.

Welcome from Tito

Thank you for downloading this program.

My name is Tito Nunez. I am a HYROX Performance Coach with 25 years of coaching experience, and Delta Zone System is a HYROX Training Club. I'm also a CrossFit L1 coach and certified personal trainer.

I built the Delta Zone System around a problem I keep seeing in hybrid athletes: they get stronger, they get fitter, they run the miles, but they still lose the race in the transition from the station back to the run.

This manual is here to change that. As you work through these sessions, stay disciplined with your pacing, protect the flush windows, and treat every transition like a skill. The goal is not random suffering. The goal is retention under pressure.

Thank you for trusting me with your training. I appreciate every athlete who downloads this and decides to do the work the right way.

- Tito

How to use this manual

Complete **3 sessions per week**. Record your **baseline runs**, track your **Delta gap** honestly, and respect the recovery bridge. The athlete who can restore control faster is the athlete who owns the transitions.

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Before you start

Read this page before Week 1. Set up your gear, know your substitutions, and scale the first two weeks if you are new to HYROX or returning from a break.

Equipment list

Rower, SkiErg, sled for push and pull, sandbag, dumbbells, wall ball, and space to run (track, treadmill, or outdoor loop).

Substitutions

If you don't have	Use instead
SkiErg	Assault / Echo bike, or high-pull dumbbell swings for the same time or calories
Rower	Bike erg, or run the same distance at the same RPE
Sled push / pull	Heavy prowler, plate push, or banded march + heavy farmers carry
Sandbag	Duffel bag loaded with plates, or dual dumbbell front rack carry / lunges
Wall ball	Goblet squat to a target, or thruster with a light dumbbell
Outdoor run space	Treadmill; keep the same distances and target paces

First-timer scaling

If this is your first HYROX block or you are coming back from time off: cap efforts at **RPE 8** in Weeks 1 and 2, cut rounds by one on circuit days, and use lighter sled and sandbag loads (about 60 to 70% of competition weight). Add the missing round or load only when you can hold form and breathing through the flush.

Safety

Consult a physician before starting this program, especially if you have a medical condition or are returning from injury. Stop any session if you feel sharp pain, dizziness, chest pain, or unusual shortness of breath. Train hard, but train smart.

Delta Zone philosophy

The Delta Zone System is built around one race truth: HYROX is not simply a running race. It is a compromised running race.

Many systems combine strength and running. The difference here is the Delta Zone philosophy that puts athletes into a constant variation environment of fatigue, flush, continue, push, repeat. The athlete learns to stabilize breathing, re-establish stride mechanics, and bridge back to target pace under pressure.

The Flushing System trains the body to clear waste while still moving.
Compromised Oxygen Training trains the athlete to maintain control at very high heart rates.
Compromised Running trains the athlete to run when the legs are already loaded with fatigue.

Delta gap calculator

Fresh pace - run **800m** at RPE 7. Then complete your trigger work. Fatigued pace - run **800m** immediately after. The difference between the two times is your Delta gap. The goal of the system is a faster fresh pace and a smaller gap.

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Week 1 - Foundation phase

Week 1 establishes the baseline and introduces the athlete to chaos, threshold work, and hybrid integration.

Day 1 - Chaos stress test

Focus: Rapid transition power. This session tests how the engine handles fast transitions between high output erg work, high skill movement, and a controlled race pace run.

1. Daily primer

Aerobic activation - 0-3 min easy jog or row at RPE 3, then 3-5 min build to RPE 6. Dynamic mobility - World's Greatest Stretch 5 per side, 90/90 hip switches 10 total, ankle dorsiflexion 10 per side, cat-cow 10 reps, inchworms plus push-up 5 reps.

2. Baseline control

800m run at RPE 7. Record the time. This is your fresh pace for the day.

3. Multi-zone chaos circuit

Format - 4 rounds. Each movement is a 2 minute block with exactly 30 seconds of rest between blocks. Rest 2 minutes between full rounds.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Row Erg	RPE 10	Maximize calories and find the redline immediately
2	DB alternating snatch	Steady	Maintain rhythm and keep the heart rate from dropping
3	Sled push	60% comp	Drive through the legs while the lungs are burning
4	Run	RPE 7	Match your 800m control pace
5	Ski Erg	RPE 10	Finish the round with max power

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Coach's note

Station 4 is the key. If you are more than 15 seconds off your fresh pace during the circuit, your Delta is too wide and you are leaking power during the sled-to-run transition.

4. Cool down

5 minute walk, then box breathing: 4 seconds in, 4 hold, 4 out, 4 hold.

Day 2 - Strength-endurance grind

Focus: Aerobic strength. The longer work blocks require a locked-in pace rather than a sprint.

Format - 3 rounds. 4 minutes of work per station with 1 minute of rest between stations.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Heavy dual DB lunges	RPE 6-7	Use heavier than comp if possible and maintain a metronome pace
2	Row Erg power strokes	RPE 6	Low stroke rate and high power on the drive
3	Sandbag clean and carry	Steady	100 ft carry plus 2 cleans to build brute strength
4	1,200m run	Threshold	Match Day 1 800m pace while extending to 1,200m

Metric for success

The 5 second rule: your 1,200m run in Round 3 should be within 5 seconds of your 1,200m run in Round 1. If form breaks down on lunges or sandbag work and you stop for more than 10 seconds, the strength base is the leak in your Delta.

Cool down - 800m very easy walk with nasal breathing only, then pigeon stretch 1 minute per side and couch stretch 1 minute per side.

Day 3 - Hybrid integration and Delta stability

Focus: Combine the chaos of Day 1 with the strength base of Day 2. The goal is to hold your Delta pace while fighting metabolic and muscular fatigue.

Format - 3 rounds for quality and pace retention. Rest 3 minutes between rounds.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Ski Erg	500m RPE 10	Trigger the system immediately
2	Farmers carry	100m heavy	Competition weight and stable posture
3	Run	800m target pace	First mirror run
4	Wall balls	20 reps	Fast and unbroken
5	Burpee broad jump	20m explosive	High output before the second run
6	Run	800m target pace	Mirror the first 800m

The mirror metric

Within each round, the second 800m should mirror the first 800m. If the second run is consistently slower, the strength movements are causing a major oxygen leak. Hold the pace you identified in your threshold work - do not sprint the first run.

Cool down - 5 minute very easy cycle or row, pigeon stretch 2 minutes per side, child's pose with reach 1 minute, and stay until your heart rate is below 100 BPM.

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Week 2 - Compression phase

Week 2 tightens the screws. The athlete already understands the baseline, so volume goes up and recovery goes down to force the Delta Zone to stabilize under density.

Day 1 - Volume accumulation and transition density

1. Baseline control - **800m** run at RPE 7. Match your Week 1 time exactly.

2. Multi-zone chaos circuit volume phase

Format - 5 rounds. 2 minutes of work and 20 seconds of rest between blocks. Rest 90 seconds between full rounds.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Row Erg	RPE 10	Sprint and try to match Week 1 calories
2	DB alternating snatch	Steady	Use breathing to lower heart rate slightly before the sled
3	Sled push	60% comp	Leg fatigue is the primary goal
4	Run	RPE 7	Hold your 800m control pace
5	Ski Erg	RPE 10	Empty the tank before round rest

Compression metric

Keep your run times within 3 seconds of your initial 800m control for all 5 rounds. If your RPE 7 run becomes an RPE 9 just to hold pace, the Delta is widening under the increased volume.

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Cool down - 5 minute easy walk with deep exhales, then quad and hip flexor stretch 90 seconds per side.

Day 2 - Movement-induced peak and the run flush

Format - 5 continuous rounds with no standing rest.

Phase	Duration	Movement	Objective
Peak	4 min	10 burpees + max distance run at RPE 8-9	Flush the noise and settle into run pace immediately
Flush	2 min	Recovery run at RPE 4-5	Stay moving and bridge the gap

Managing the transition

Move through the 10 burpees aggressively. The moment the 10th burpee ends, hit your run pace in the first 5 meters. During the 2 minute flush, use the double nasal inhale and long exhale so you are ready the second the next round starts.

Metric - Track distance covered during each 4 minute run block. All 5 rounds should stay within 15-20 meters. A drop of more than 30 meters proves the system is not flushing the fatigue from the burpees.

Cool down - 400m walk, couch stretch 2 minutes per side, calf stretch 1 minute per side.

Day 3 - Structural peak and the recovery bridge

Format - 6 rounds on a continuous clock with no standing rest. Each round uses a movement buy-in before the run.

Phase	Duration	Movement	Objective
Peak	5 min	Movement buy-in + max run at RPE 8-9	Create structural fatigue and then force the run
Flush	2 min	Recovery run at RPE 4-5	Drain the legs and bridge back to control

Movement buy-in rotation - Rounds 1 and 4: 20m sled push at competition weight. Rounds 2 and 5: 20m sandbag walking lunge at competition weight. Rounds 3 and 6: 20 wall balls.

Lunge-to-run transition

After the lunges, exaggerate knee drive for the first 50 meters of the run to break the muscular tension. Use long exhales in the 2 minute flush because lunges create a lot of internal pressure.

Metric - Compare total run distance after the sled to total run distance after the sandbag lunges. If the lunge run is 50m shorter, structural stability is leaking and you are spending too much time finding your legs.

Cool down - 1,000m very easy walk or jog, couch stretch 2 minutes per side, pigeon stretch 1 minute per side.

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Week 3 - Performance and re-test

Week 3 is about proof. The exact same baseline test returns so the athlete can see whether the gap is actually closing.

Day 1 - Re-test baseline assessment

Phase 1 - **800m** run at RPE 7. Beat your Week 1 fresh pace by 2-4 seconds without increasing effort and record the exact time.

Phase 2 - 4 rounds at RPE 10 of 15 wall balls, 10 burpees, 200m sprint. Rest 60 seconds between rounds.

Phase 3 - Immediately run **800m** and try to match your Phase 1 time exactly.

Week 3 metric
Compare your Week 1 Delta gap to your Week 3 Delta gap. If the gap is smaller, your flush and bridge work is working. If the gap is the same, the threshold is improving but recovery protocols need more attention. If the gap is larger, the nervous system is overreaching and recovery breathing needs priority.

Cool down - 1,000m walk with nasal breathing only, couch stretch 2 minutes per side, pigeon stretch 1 minute per side.

Day 2 - Race-pace compromised engine

Focus: Performance-week compromised running. Bridge from the Day 1 re-test into station fatigue that mirrors race pace, then prove you can hold your target run after sled, row, and lunges.

Format - 4 rounds. Complete the station block, then immediately run 400m at race pace. Rest 90 seconds between full rounds.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Sled push	20m @ 70-80% comp	Load the legs without redlining the lungs
2	Row Erg	250m RPE 8	Race-pace pull; settle stroke rate, not a sprint
3	Sandbag walking lunges	20m comp	Structural fatigue before the run
4	Run	400m race pace	Hit the bridge in the first 10 meters after the lunges

Race-pace metric
All four 400m runs should stay within 3 seconds of each other. If Round 4 is more than 5 seconds slower than Round 1, the sled-to-lunge sequence is widening your Delta. Shorten the rest only if you are holding pace and breathing under control.

Cool down - 800m easy walk with nasal breathing, couch stretch 2 minutes per side, hip flexor stretch 90 seconds per side.

Day 3 - The no-exit hybrid

Engine buy-in - 3,000m run at RPE 7. Transition immediately into the circuit with zero rest.

Format - 4 rounds. Move station to station with no standing rest inside the round. Rest 2 minutes between rounds if needed to protect form.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Burpee broad jump	20m explosive	Move with rhythm and no hesitation
2	Wall balls	25 reps unbroken	If broken, max 3 second reset
3	Run	200m RPE 10	The Delta trigger
4	Sled pull	20m comp	Use the legs, not just the arms
5	Run	100m RPE 5	The flush and only true bridge window

100m flush

The 100m RPE 5 run is the key. Force turnover in the first 10 meters after the sled pull and use Delta breathing - double inhale, long exhale. If heart rate does not drop here, the next wall ball set will break.

Metric - Track how many times you had to take a 3 second wall ball reset. Zero breaks across all 4 rounds is the target. Breaks in Rounds 3 or 4 show the flush is not doing its job.

Cool down - 1,000m very easy walk with nasal breathing, couch stretch 2 minutes per side, pigeon stretch 1 minute per side.

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

Week 4 - Peak and realization

Week 4 proves the system under maximum race-simulation stress. The engine has been built. The bridge must now hold.

Day 1 - Engine realization and lactic ceiling

Peak ceiling test - 4 rounds of 1,500m run at **threshold pace** with 60 seconds rest.

What is threshold pace?

Use your Week 3 fresh 800m pace plus 5 to 8 seconds per 400m, or RPE 8. Example: if your Week 3 fresh 800m was 3:20 (1:40 per 400m), threshold is about 1:45 to 1:48 per 400m. Hold that even effort across all four 1,500m repeats.

Consistency metric

Every 1,500m should be within 4 seconds of the first run. If the final round drops by more than 10 seconds, the system is still leaking at high volume.

Day 2 - Efficiency realization, the no-exit evolution

Buy-in - 3,000m run at RPE 7, then go immediately into the circuit.

Station	Movement	Intensity	Delta focus
1	Burpee broad jump	20m explosive	Raise the heart rate immediately
2	Wall balls	30 reps unbroken	If the ball drops, 5 burpee penalty
3	Run	400m RPE 10	Longer Delta trigger than Week 3
4	Sled pull	20m comp	Heavy structural pull under fatigue
5	Run	200m RPE 4-5	The only bridge window in the round

DELTA ZONE SYSTEM

The bridge in Week 4

The 200m flush is your only chance to recover. The athlete must control breathing and re-establish stride mechanics before the next burpee broad jump starts.

Day 3 - Final Delta baseline

Phase 1 - **800m** run at RPE 7. Record time. Phase 2 - 5 rounds of 15 wall balls, 10 burpees, 200m sprint with 45 seconds rest. Phase 3 - **800m** realization run. Match the first run if possible.

Week	Fresh 800m	Fatigued 800m	Delta gap
Week 1	_____	_____	_____
Week 3	_____	_____	_____
Week 4	_____	_____	_____

Victory condition

If your fresh 800m is faster and your gap is smaller than Week 1, you have successfully mastered the Delta Zone. You no longer survive the stations - you own the transitions.

Thank you

Thank you again for downloading the Delta Zone System. I appreciate every athlete who puts real work into the details that most people ignore. That is where races change.

If this program helped you, keep building the engine and keep bridging the gap. Stay consistent, track your data, and continue training the flush, the breathing, and the transition discipline that separate good athletes from prepared racers.

I am grateful you trusted me with your training.

See you in the Roxzone,

Tito

Next step
After this block, review your Week 1 versus Week 4 scorecard. Decide whether the next phase should emphasize threshold, structural fatigue tolerance, or movement-to-run bridge work. Then build the next cycle from the data, not emotion.

Want more coaching?
Ready for 1-on-1 programming, weekly check-ins, and direct access to Coach Tito? Apply for coaching at deltazonesystem.com (from $129/mo).

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